

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
Daniel Sostre, :

: Index Number:
Date Purchased:
Date Filed:

Plaintiffs : SUMMONS

-against- :

City of New York, New York City Police Department, :
Police Officer Tatiana Cruz, Shield 400 of NARCBBX, :
Detective Asim Sheikh, Shield 3416 of NARCBBX, :
Undercover Police Officer John Doe and New York City :
Police Officers John Doe, :

Plaintiff's residence is:
304 Echo Place
Bronx, NY 10457.

Defendants :

-----X

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to Answer the Verified Complaint in this action and serve a copy of your answer, or if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons to serve a notice of Appearance on the Plaintiffs attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Verified Complaint.

The basis of venue designated is that the cause of action arose in Bronx County.

Dated: December 27, 2018
Bronx, NY

Yours, etc.,

LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
Attorney for Plaintiffs
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-7007

To: City of New York

New York City Police Department

Police Officer Tatiana Cruz, Shield 400 of NARCBBX

Detective Asim Sheikh, Shield 3416 of NARCBBX

Undercover Police Officer John Doe

New York City Police Officers John Doe

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X	:	
Daniel Sostre,	:	
	:	
Plaintiffs	:	VERIFIED COMPLAINT
	:	
-against-	:	
	:	
City of New York, New York City Police Department,	:	
Police Officer Tatiana Cruz, Shield 400 of NARCBBX,	:	
Detective Asim Sheikh, Shield 3416 of NARCBBX,	:	
Undercover Police Officer John Doe and New York City	:	
Police Officers John Doe,	:	
	:	
Defendants	:	
-----X	:	

Plaintiff, by and through his attorney, JASON A. STEINBERGER, Esq, for his complaint,
alleges upon information and belief as follows:

STATEMENT OF FACTS

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff Daniel Sostre (hereinafter referred to as "SOSTRE") resides in Bronx, State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Police Officer Tatiana Cruz, Shield 400 of NARCBBX (hereinafter referred to as "CRUZ") was employed by the New York City Police Department.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Detective Asim Sheikh, Shield 3416 of NARCBBX (hereinafter referred to as "SHEIKH") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Undercover Police Officer John Doe, (hereinafter referred to as "UC DOE") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, New York City Police Officers John Doe, those officers involved in the arrested of SOSTRE (hereinafter referred to as "DOES") were employed by the New York City Police Department.

6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York State of New York.

7. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.

8. On or before about July 6, 2018 notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs' claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.

9. That on or about September 13, 2018 a hearing required by Municipal Law 50-H was taken. At said hearing Plaintiff testified and set forth the facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York in response to this claim, and more than thirty (30) days have elapsed.

10. That on or about March 16, 2018 approximately 8:30PM, in the vicinity of 304 Echo Place, Bronx, NY Plaintiff was walking towards the store to get something to eat when UC DOE and another individual approached Plaintiff.

11. That the other individual requested Plaintiff to walk down the street with him and UC DOE.
12. That Plaintiff declined and continued on his way to towards the store.
13. That CRUZ and SHEIKH and DOES stopped, handcuffed and arrested Plaintiff.
14. That at no time did Plaintiff engage in any criminal or unlawful conduct.
15. That at no time did Plaintiff possess or attempt to possess a controlled substance.
16. That at no time did Plaintiff sell or attempt to sell a controlled substance.
17. That after Plaintiff was arrested, he was transported to the 46 precinct.
18. That while Plaintiff was at the 46 precinct, he was held in a cell with numerous other male prisoners for several hours.
19. That while Plaintiff was at the 46 precinct, he was strip searched that nothing of an illegal or unlawful nature was recovered.
20. That after being held for several hours at the 46 precinct, Plaintiff was transported to Bronx County Central Booking located at 215 East 161 Street, Bronx, NY 10451.
21. That while held at Bronx County Central Booking located at 215 East 161 Street, Bronx, NY 10451, Plaintiff was held in a cell with other males for several hours.
22. That on or about March 18, 2018 Plaintiff was arraigned on docket 2018BX008954 where he was charged with Criminal Sale of a Controlled Substance in the Third Degree and related offenses.
23. That at the time of the arraignment, Plaintiff was released on his own recognizance and ordered to return to court.
24. That on or about May 25, 2018 Plaintiff testified before the Grand Jury in connection with the above arrest and case.

25. That on or about May 25, 2018, the Grand Jury voted a No True Bill and the case against Plaintiff was dismissed.

26. That on and between March 18, 2018 and May 25, 2018 Plaintiff made several court appearances until the case was dismissed.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

27. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 26, as if more fully stated herein at length.

28. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.

29. That as a result of the actions of Defendants, Plaintiff was seriously injured due to the intentional manner in which Defendants, their agents, servants, employees and/or licensees treated Plaintiff and he was wounded, suffered, still suffers, and will continue to suffer for some time great physical pain and great bodily injuries and became sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remained for a considerable length of time.

30. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

31. That as a result of the actions by Defendants Plaintiff was traumatized and fears for his physical safety when he sees and encounters members of the New York City Police Department from that day and onward.

32. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.

33. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff was forced to miss multiple days from work.

34. That as a result of the Defendants' actions Plaintiff sustained damage to his person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

35. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 34, as if more fully stated herein at length.

36. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution by Defendants violated the rights of Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable.

37. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff did, nevertheless, unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward her and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for his constitutional rights. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

38. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 37, as if more fully stated herein at length.

39. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec.1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable. Thus Plaintiff Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

40. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 39, as if more fully stated herein at length.

41. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff to suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable. The verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution on and of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

42. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by persisting in claiming that Plaintiff sold and possessed a controlled substance when he in fact had not.

43. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to cooperate in a prosecution when Plaintiff should never have been arrested. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

44. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 43, as if more fully stated herein at length.

45. At all times pertinent hereto, CRUZ, SHEIKH, UC DOE and DOES were acting within the scope of their employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and City of New York.

46. The City of New York and New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the intentional torts that CRUZ, SHEIKH, UC DOE and DOES committed within the scope of their employment.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

47. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 46, as if more fully stated herein at length.

48. The City of New York and New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to CRUZ, SHEIKH, UC DOE and DOES constitutes a willful and wanton indifference and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of private citizens, including Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

49. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 48, as if more fully stated herein at length.

50. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff.

51. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory

that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants as follows:

On the first cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts;

On the second cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts, together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the third cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

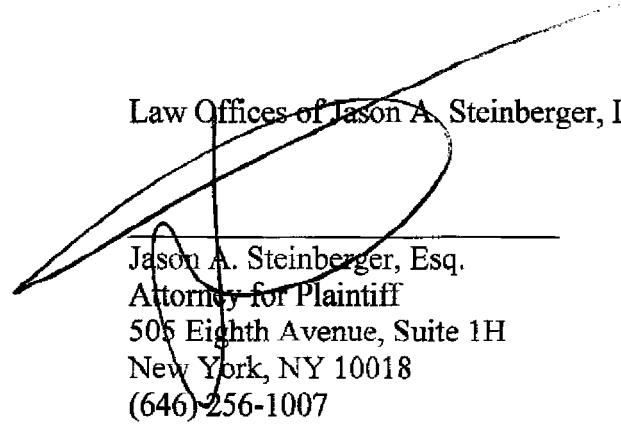
On the fourth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the Defendants' wanton and willful actions;

On the fifth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts

On the sixth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additiona7l exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts.

On the seventh cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

Law Offices of Jason A. Steinberger, LLC

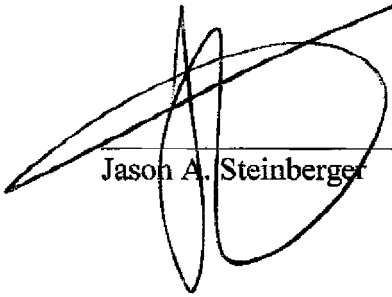


Jason A. Steinberger, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

STATE OF NEW YORK: COUNTY OF NEW YORK

The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury, affirms the following to be true: Affirmant has read the foregoing Complaint and the contents thereof; the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge, except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters affirmant believes it to be true; and the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not by the plaintiff is because the plaintiff is not within the county in which your affirmant maintains his principal office. The grounds of affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon affirmant's knowledge are communications with the plaintiff, review of records and documents within affirmant's possession.

Affirmed: December 27, 2018



Jason A. Steinberger